From fish skin to Nordic unicorn

Founded 2009 by Fertram Sigurjónsson

Kerecis®

SPHERE - OCEAN

Kerecis was founded on the insight that fish skin's collagen structure closely resembles human skin, combined with the founder's prior medtech experience and deep understanding of the US medical and insurance landscape.

Rooted in Iceland's fishing industry, Kerecis transformed a low-value fish byproduct into a high-value medical technology — creating skilled jobs in a rural region while building a globally successful company.

The result
one of the Nordic region's first circular-economy unicorns, demonstrating that sustainability and commercial value can reinforce each other.

$1.3Bn
MAXIMUM ACQUISITION VALUE

DKK 510M
PRE-ACQUISITION REVENUE, FY2021/22

~5%
US BIOLOGICS MARKET SHARE

INVESTMENT THESIS

Turning an underutilised biological resource into a clinically proven product creates better outcomes and substantial commercial value.

from BELIEF *to* BANKABILITY

The fastest-growing segment in a DKK 55bn market

Kerecis entered the biologics segment of advanced wound care — a fast-growing market concentrated almost entirely in the US.

FAST GROWTH

High-single-digit annual growth

Biologics is the fastest-growing segment within advanced wound care.

US SCALE

The opportunity is concentrated

The US represents DKK 14bn of the DKK 15bn biologics market.

STRONG POSITION

An established foothold

Kerecis held ~5% market share and the #5 position in the US.

KEY MARKET DRIVERS

Ageing populations, increasing chronic wounds and growing adoption of biologic treatments.

Kerecis combined a differentiated technology with an early position in one of advanced wound care's fastest-growing segments.

One fish. Multiple value streams

Kerecis increases the value extracted from each fish by turning an underutilized byproduct — fish skin — into a high-value medical technology.

01 — SOURCE
Fish skin from sustainable Icelandic fisheries. Rooted in Iceland's local fishing economy, creating jobs and economic opportunities in the region.

PART OF ICELAND'S WIDER "100% FISH" VALUE NETWORK

02 — PRESERVE
Gentle processing retains the skin's natural structure, with production carried out in Kerecis-owned facilities close to the source in Iceland.

03 — TRANSFORM
Patented technology creates regulated medical products

04 — HEAL
The products support tissue regeneration and wound healing

05 — SCALE
A differentiated platform in a large and growing market.

FROM BY-PRODUCT TO MEDICAL VALUE

VALUE CREATED ACROSS THE MODEL

ENVIRONMENTAL
More value from an existing biological resource — reducing waste by turning fish skin into a high-value medical product.

MEDICAL
Supporting tissue regeneration and wound healing

ECONOMIC
From low-value by-product to high-value product

REGIONAL
High-skilled economic activity in Iceland

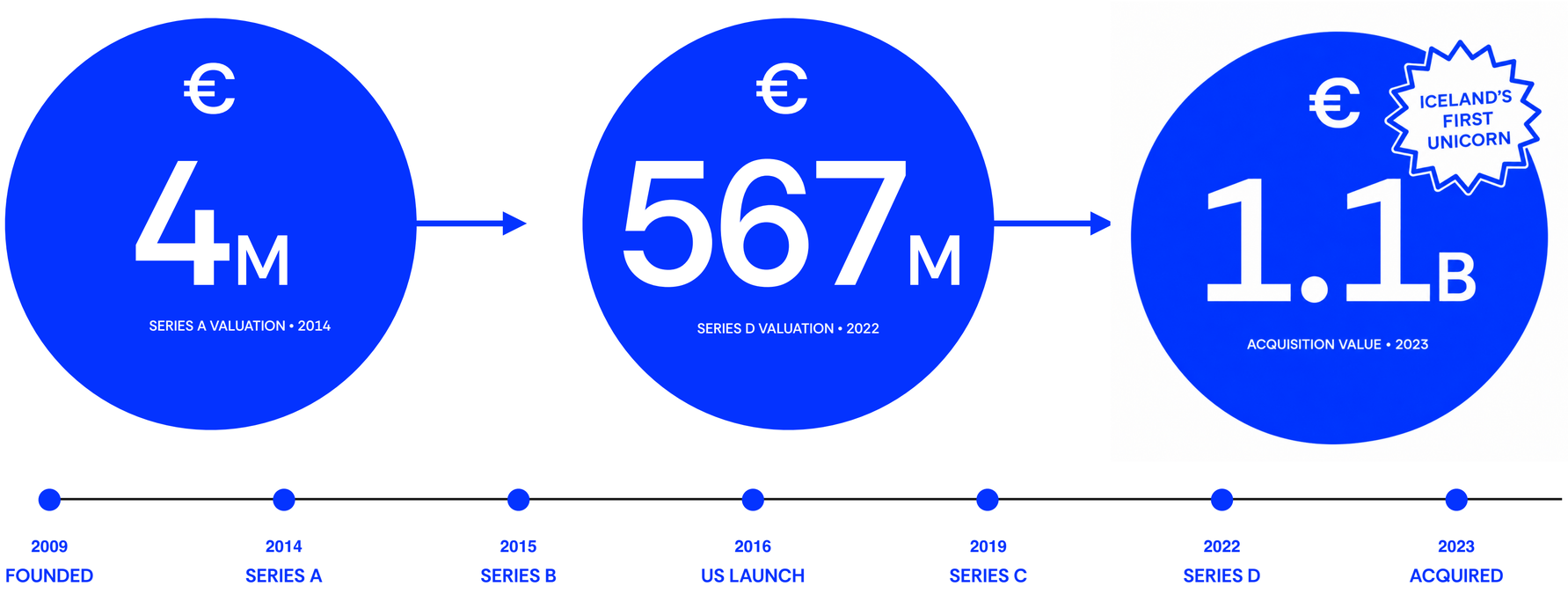
The circular model is not an ESG add-on. It is part of the product's clinical and commercial value proposition.

Kerecis

From a €4m valuation to a €1.1bn acquisition

Kerecis started with very limited resources, with the founders initially bootstrapping the business. Early public grants, local partnerships and a significant seed investment then provided the capital needed to build R&D capabilities and its first production facility.

Acquisition value shown in EUR; maximum transaction value communicated as approximately USD 1.3bn.



COMMERCIAL PROOF

DKK 510M
Revenue FY2021/22

BREAK-EVEN
Reached FY2021/22

98%
Revenue generated in the US

20,000+ PATIENTS
TREATED GLOBALLY

THE COMMERCIAL THESIS

Early investors took a risk on an unproven circular model — helping turn fish skin from an idea into an investable, scalable business.

The advantage is the platform, not the fish skin

Kerecis combines access to an abundant local resource with patented technology, proven clinical outcomes, proprietary production capabilities and deep knowledge of the US medical market. This creates a differentiated and defensible platform, where local sourcing, vertical integration and circularity support both scalability and long-term value creation.

01 — RESOURCE

An abundant, underutilised input

Fish skin is sourced as a by-product from Icelandic fisheries. Less than 1% of the available Icelandic cod supply was used by Kerecis at the time of acquisition.

02 — DIFFERENTIATION

Preserving what makes the material valuable

Gentle processing retains the fish skin's natural structure, creating a differentiated biological product.

03 — PROTECTION

Building evidence and barriers to entry

Patented production, regulatory approval and clinical evidence strengthen confidence in the technology.

04 — SCALE

Turning innovation into a platform

Growing adoption creates commercial scale and supports expansion across chronic, surgical and burn wounds — extending the platform into additional applications and markets.

Kerecis®

BUILDING NORDIC RESILIENCE

Early public investment helped turn a local biological resource into a resilient, high-value industry — creating jobs, strengthening regional value creation and reducing reliance on external supply chains.

The resource may be abundant. The investable advantage comes from technology, evidence and market access.

What Kerecis teaches us about investing in circular innovation

Kerecis demonstrates that circularity can be more than an environmental benefit. When combined with technology, evidence and market access, it can become a source of competitive advantage and commercial value.

INVESTOR RELEVANCE

STAGE
Early venture → growth → strategic exit

INVESTMENT TYPE
Venture capital / growth equity

SECTOR
Regenerative medicine / advanced wound care / circular bioeconomy

WHY INVEST
Proprietary technology + clinical proof + US market scale

01 CIRCULARITY CREATES VALUE

Turns a low-value byproduct into a high-value medical product.

02 RESOURCE ACCESS IS AN ADVANTAGE

Local sourcing and production create supply security and value-chain control.

03 SCIENCE ALONE IS NOT ENOUGH

Patents, clinical evidence and market expertise turn innovation into a viable business.

04 CAPITAL WAS A CATALYST

Early investment funded the R&D and production infrastructure needed to scale.

05 LOCAL ROOTS, GLOBAL REACH

Built on an existing fishing industry. Infrastructure and access to raw materials to develop a globally medtech business

- FISH VALLEY -

06 SUSTAINABILITY CAN BE BANKABLE

Kerecis demonstrates that circularity can translate into competitive advantage and significant economic value.

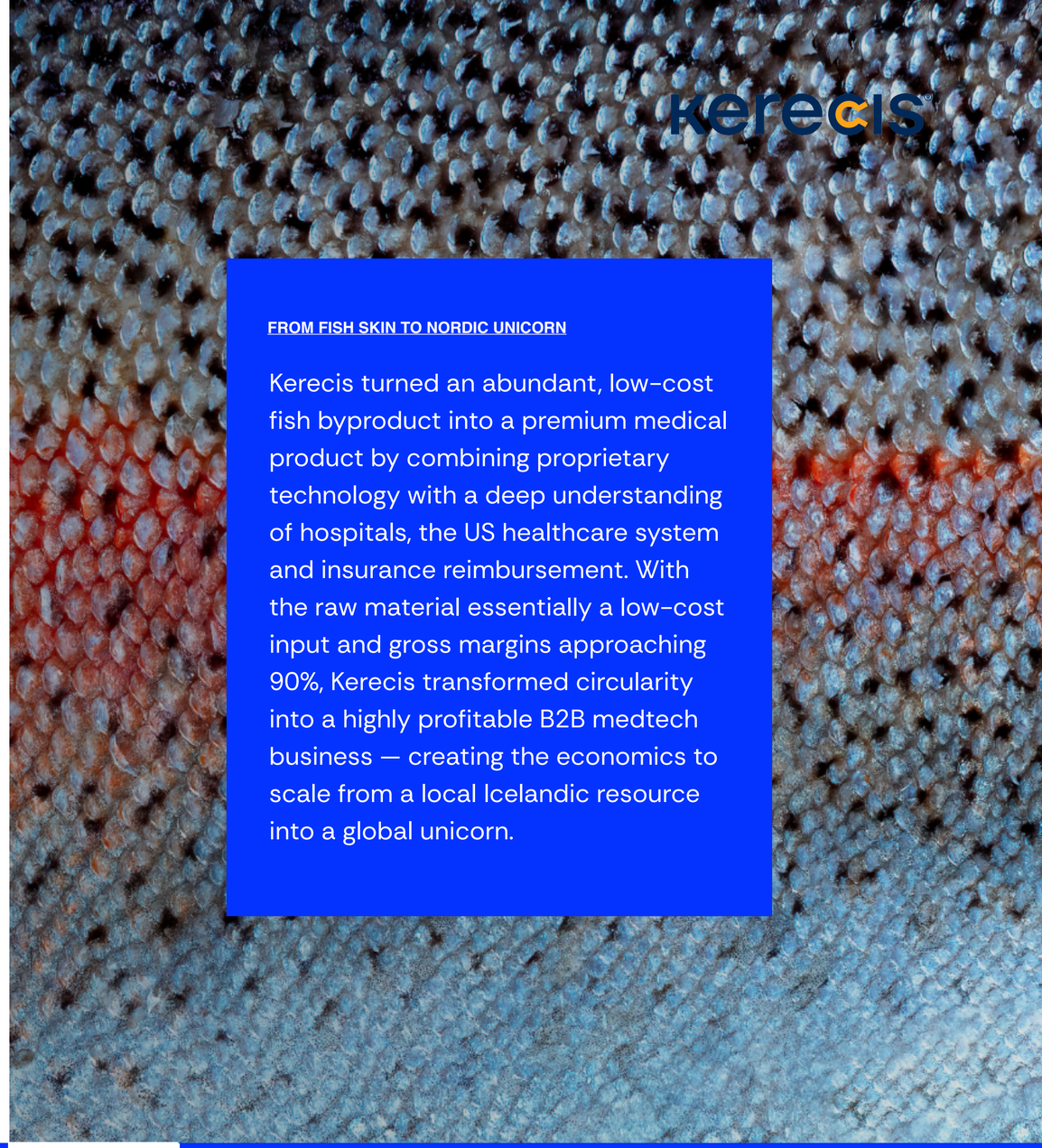
Circularity can be the foundation of competitive advantage.

Kerecis shows how an underutilised biological resource can support better outcomes, a defensible technology platform and substantial commercial value.

THE INVESTOR VIEW

"We acquired Kerecis because it demonstrated an exceptional ability to heal wounds and improve patients' lives through a unique fish skin technology. Equally inspiring was how Kerecis turned a natural by-product into high value medical innovation, with significant clinical and commercial impact and strong physician adoption"

Thomas Kondrup Hardahl
Coloplast, Senior Director of Strategy & Development, Wound & Tissue Repair



FROM FISH SKIN TO NORDIC UNICORN

Kerecis turned an abundant, low-cost fish byproduct into a premium medical product by combining proprietary technology with a deep understanding of hospitals, the US healthcare system and insurance reimbursement. With the raw material essentially a low-cost input and gross margins approaching 90%, Kerecis transformed circularity into a highly profitable B2B medtech business — creating the economics to scale from a local Icelandic resource into a global unicorn.

THE MARKET THESIS

Circular value uplift becomes investable when combined with science, evidence and global market access.

THE INVESTOR VIEW

"Some of the strongest circular opportunities may not carry a green label. Energy savings, productive use of by-products and better food preservation can create both environmental and strategic value"

Hrönn Greipsdottir
CEO, The New Business Venture Fund Kria – Iceland Venture Initiative

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BANKABILITY INDICATORS

1. CLINICALLY PROVEN, DIFFERENTIATED TECHNOLOGY

Patented fish-skin technology, clinical evidence and strong physician adoption created a differentiated medical product with established therapeutic value.

2. PROVEN COMMERCIAL TRACTION AND MARKET ACCESS

Kerecis reached DKK 510m in revenue and break-even in FY2021/22, with 98% of revenue generated in the US. Its position in the advanced wound-care biologics market demonstrated the value of combining clinical innovation with deep knowledge of the US healthcare and reimbursement system.

3. ICELAND'S FIRST UNICORN

Kerecis transformed a low-value fish-processing by-product into a high-value medical product, with gross margins approaching 90%. Local sourcing, proprietary production capabilities and vertical integration supported a scalable business, culminating in an acquisition valued at up to approximately $1.3bn.

from BELIEF *to* BANKABILITY

A Nordic initiative turning circular ideas into investable business

NORDIC CIRCULAR INVESTMENTS